

Digital Branding - Ad creation

Part 1: Deep Dive into Video Ad Types

In a professional digital strategy, we choose the format based on the **Marketing Funnel**:

- **Awareness (Top of Funnel):** Use **Bumper Ads (6s)** or **Skippable In-Stream**. The goal is reach and frequency.
- **Consideration (Middle of Funnel):** Use **In-Feed Discovery Ads**. These appear when users are actively searching for a solution, making them high-intent.
- **Conversion (Bottom of Funnel):** Use **Non-Skippable In-Stream (15s)** or **Social Stories**. These drive immediate action via a "Shop Now" button.

The "Skippability" Psychology

- **The 5-Second Rule:** On YouTube, you have 5 seconds to provide a "reason to stay." If the brand is revealed *after* 5 seconds, you lose the audience.
- **The "Sound-Off" Strategy:** 80% of social media videos are watched without sound. A "good" ad must tell the full story through **kinetic typography** (moving text) and visual cues alone.

In digital marketing, the **placement** dictates the **creative strategy**.

Ad Type	Platform	Key Characteristic	Practical Example
Bumper Ads	YouTube	6 seconds, non-skippable.	FoodPanda: A quick 6-second shot of a steaming biryani pot with the text "Hungry? 20% off now."
In-Stream (Skippable)	YouTube	Skip button appears after 5s.	Samsung: A 2-minute cinematic launch of the S24. The first 5s must show the phone's best feature to prevent skipping.
Vertical/Shorts	TikTok/Reels	9:16 aspect ratio, immersive.	SkinCare Brand: A "Get Ready With Me" (GRWM) style video where an influencer uses the product naturally.
In-Feed Ads	Google/YT Search	Click-to-play thumbnail.	Coursera: A thumbnail saying "Master Python in 30 Days" appearing when you search for coding tutorials.

II. The 4 Criteria of a High-Conversion Ad

A "good" ad isn't just pretty; it performs. Use these four pillars:

1. **The 3-Second "Thumb-Stop":** You must interrupt the user's dopamine scroll.
 - *Example:* Start with a question like "Are you overpaying for your mobile data?" or a visual of something breaking.
2. **Sound-Independent Clarity:** Assume the user is in a quiet office or on a bus without headphones.
 - *Example:* Use **Bold Captions** that mirror the voiceover. If the narrator says "50% Off," that text should flash on the screen.
3. **The "One-Value" Rule:** Don't list 10 features. Pick **one** core benefit.
 - *Example:* **Ariel Detergent** doesn't talk about scent, price, and packaging at once; they focus on "Removing tough stains in 1 wash."
4. **Native Feel:** The ad should look like content, not a commercial.
 - *Example:* Using a handheld phone camera for a Reel ad rather than a high-end cinema camera makes it feel more "authentic" to Gen Z.

Part 2: Advanced Storytelling Frameworks

Moving beyond basic narrative, we use the **Hook-Value-Call to Action** model, often enhanced by the **PAS** (Problem-Agitation-Solution) framework:

1. **The Hook (0-3s):** Stop the scroll. Use a "pattern interrupt"—something visually or conceptually unexpected.
 - *Example:* "Why 90% of Digital Marketers fail at SEO."
 2. **The Agitation (3-15s):** Make the problem "hurt." Describe the frustration of wasted budget or low reach.
 3. **The Solution (15-25s):** Introduce the product as the bridge between the current "pain state" and the desired "heaven state."
 4. **The CTA (25-30s):** The "Last Mile." Be direct. "Download the Guide" or "Book a Consult."
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Storytelling in 30 seconds requires a tight structure. The most effective for marketing is **Problem-Agitation-Solution (PAS)**.

- **Problem:** Identify a specific pain point.
 - *Example:* A student struggling to organize research papers for a thesis at FAST NUCES.
- **Agitation:** Make that pain feel urgent.
 - *Example:* Show a "Submission Failed" screen or a pile of messy notebooks with a ticking clock sound.
- **Solution:** Introduce the product as the "Hero."
 - *Example:* "Organize your life with Notion. Templates built for students."

Part 3: 30-Second Storyboard (Sample)

This can be used as a classroom exercise for students to build in Canva.

Time	Visual	Audio/Text
0-5s	A person looking frustrated at a blank laptop screen.	Text: Stuck on your marketing strategy?
5-15s	Quick cuts of confusing charts, "Error" messages, and coffee cups.	Text: Stop guessing. Start growing.
15-25s	Screen recording of a clean dashboard showing growth (use a Canva Frame).	Text: Data-driven insights in one click.
25-30s	Brand logo with a bright "Start Free Trial" button.	Text: Link in Bio.

IV. Practical Canva Workflow: Creating the 30s Ad

To create a professional ad in Canva, follow this **Scene Breakdown**:

Scene 1: The Hook (0-5s)

- **Visual:** Use a high-quality stock video of someone looking stressed or a vibrant color background.
- **Action:** Add a "Typewriter" animation to your headline text.
- **Example:** "Stop Wasting Time on Manual SEO."

Scene 2: The Proof/Benefit (5-20s)

- **Visual:** Use **Canva Frames**. Go to *Elements > Frames > Laptop*. Drag your screen-recording or product photo into the laptop frame.
- **Action:** Add "Stickers" or "Graphics" like arrows pointing to key features.
- **Example:** Show a graph moving upward.

Scene 3: The Social Proof/Trust (20-25s)

- **Visual:** Small headshots of "customers" with 5-star icons.
- **Action:** Use the "Fade" transition to keep it smooth.
- **Example:** "Join 10,000+ Marketers in Pakistan."

Scene 4: The Call to Action (25-30s)

- **Visual:** A solid brand-colored background (e.g., FAST Blue or Brand Orange).
- **Action:** A big, pulsing button.
- **Example:** "Click the Link Below to Start."